
HARDWARE



Apple has now sold 3
billion iPhones



Apple has sold 3 billion iPhones since the product was launched in 2007, Apple CEO Tim Cook said Thursday during the company's third-quarter earnings call.

It took Apple nine years to sell the billionth iPhone, a milestone the company [reached](#) in 2016. This implies that Apple sold 2 billion between 2016 and now — also a nine-year period — marking the product's growing popularity.

While Apple celebrates 3 billion iPhones sold, the company has struggled a bit in the stock market this year, as the tech giant fell behind Nvidia and Microsoft as the market's most highly valued businesses. So perhaps a bigger cause for celebration at Apple is that its [iPhone sales were stronger](#) this quarter than expected.

Sales of the iPhone, Apple's most popular product, are up 13% year-over-year, generating \$44.6 billion in revenue, according to information shared on the earnings call. That's nearly half of the entire company's [total revenue](#) this quarter, which reached \$94 billion.

This uptick in iPhone sales might be temporary, though. Apple expert and Bloomberg managing editor Mark Gurman mused that the company may have sold more iPhones last quarter over fears that President Trump's tariff plans would exponentially increase prices in the United States.

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Mark Gurman 
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Apple should be very pleased with the folks who spread the lies that the iPhone will cost \$3000 or \$25,000 if made in the U.S. Clearly that helped a ton for the June quarter.

8:50 PM · Jul 31, 2025 

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IMAGE CREDITS: TEAONHER (MODIFIED)

SECURITY



TeaOnHer, a rival Tea app for men, is leaking users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling, Zack Whittaker

12:40 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

TeaOnHer, an app designed for men to share photos and information about women they have supposedly dated, has exposed users' personal information, including government IDs and selfies, TechCrunch can confirm.

The app, which launched on the Apple App Store earlier this week, is a response to another viral app Tea that allows women to post about the men they date. Tea is advertised as a women's safety app with more than 6 million users that is similar to "[Are we dating the same guy?](#)" Facebook networks. However, the app is controversial, since many of the claims that women post cannot be verified.

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The backlash surrounding Tea escalated last week, after 404 Media reported 4chan users retaliated by [discovering a publicly exposed database](#) belonging to the app, which [revealed](#) over 72,000 images, including thousands of selfies and photo IDs submitted for account verification. A [subsequent hack](#) exposed more than 1 million private messages sent over the app, prompting the app to [disable](#) its messaging feature.

TeaOnHer, which is now ranked No. 2 among Lifestyle apps on iOS, appears to be a direct rebuttal to the Tea app, even copying the language from Tea's App Store description in its own listing.

But like the app it sought to emulate, TeaOnHer contains security flaws of its own.

TechCrunch has found at least one security flaw that allows anyone access to data belonging to TeaOnHer app users, including their usernames and associated email addresses, as well as driver's licenses and selfies that users uploaded to TeaOnHer. Images of these driver's licenses are publicly accessible web addresses, allowing anyone with the links to access them using their web browser.

In one case, TechCrunch saw a list of posts shared on TeaOnHer appended with each user's email address, display name, and self-reported location.

TechCrunch is withholding some of the details of the bugs so as to not help malicious actors access anyone's data. The app's maker did not respond to emails from TechCrunch asking who we can report the flaws to. As such, TechCrunch is publishing this report with limited details of the issue, given the app's current popularity and the risk faced with using the app.

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TeaOnHer was uploaded to the iOS App Store by a developer named Newville Media Corporation. According to LinkedIn, the founder and CEO of this company is Xavier Lampkin.

TechCrunch identified at least one TeaOnHer record associated with Lampkin's own data.

The security lapse will likely affect any user who signed up or shared identity documents with the app. The bug also exposes the number of users the TeaOnHer app has, which is about 53,000 users at the time of publication.

TechCrunch also identified a potential second security issue, in which an email address and plaintext password belonging to the app's creator, Lampkin, was left exposed on the server. The credentials appear to grant access to the app's "admin" panel. TechCrunch did not use the credentials, as doing so would be unlawful, but highlights the risks of inadvertently leaving admin credentials exposed to the web.

Along with its security flaws, the content portrayed within TeaOnHer is troubling in itself. While the app requests IDs and selfies from its users to verify their identities — a process that is not automatic — users can access a "guest" view of the app without signing in.

Immediately upon opening "guest" view, TechCrunch saw several images of the same naked woman, posted under different names in a form of spam. It is not clear if this woman consented to this photo being shared. Other posts share the photos and names of women, alongside comments calling them "easy," or accusing them of spreading sexually transmitted infections.

Across all free apps, TeaOnHer is ranked No. 17, higher than apps like Instagram, Netflix, Uber, and

Spotify. Tea is currently ranked No. 2.

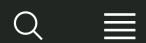
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APPS



The backlash against Duolingo going 'AI-first' didn't even matter

Amanda Silberling — 8:32 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

Duolingo [announced](#) on Wednesday that it beat its quarterly revenue estimates, even though the company faced widespread backlash for choosing to embrace generative AI over human workers. Duolingo stock rose [almost 30%](#) on the news.

In April, CEO Luis von Ahn [shared](#) that Duolingo would become an “AI-first” company, phasing out its use of contract workers. He also discouraged teams from hiring more employees, unless the team is unable to automate more of its work. With the use of generative AI, Duolingo introduced 148 new language courses, more than doubling its previous offerings.

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“Without AI, it would take us decades to scale our content to more learners,” von Ahn wrote at the time. “We owe it to our learners to get them this content ASAP.”

While some Duolingo users have argued that these AI features are making the app worse, the company’s financial metrics tell a different story. Now the company [anticipates](#) making over \$1 billion in revenue this year, and daily active users have grown 40% year-over-year. The growth is significant but falls in the lower range of the company’s estimates of growing between 40% and 45%, which an investor brought up to von Ahn on Wednesday’s quarterly earnings call.

“The reason we came [in] towards the lower end was because I said some stuff about AI, and I didn’t give enough context. Because of that, we got some backlash on social media,” von Ahn said. “The most important thing is we wanted to make the sentiment on our social media positive. We stopped posting edgy posts and started posting things that would get our sentiment more positive. That has worked.”

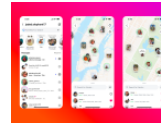
On TikTok, the top comments on Duolingo’s videos often remain criticisms of the company’s AI approach. Snarky commenters will ask if videos with multiple people in them are made with AI, to which Duolingo will reply, “Nope. Made by our great team!”

But even if public sentiment toward Duolingo has shifted, its bottom line has not ... and from the company’s perspective, that’s what matters.

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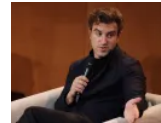
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AI



Microsoft brings
OpenAI's smallest open
model to Windows users

Microsoft is making OpenAI's new free and open GPT model, [gpt-oss-20b](#), available to Windows 11 users via [Windows AI Foundry](#), the tech giant's platform that lets users tap AI features, APIs, and popular open source models on their computers.

The company said in a [blog post](#) that gpt-oss-20b is "tool-savvy and lightweight," adding: "Optimized for agentic tasks like code execution and tool use, it runs efficiently on a range of Windows hardware, with support for more devices coming soon. It's perfect for building autonomous assistants or embedding into real-world workflows, even in bandwidth-constrained environments."

Launched on Tuesday, OpenAI's gpt-oss-20b can run on consumer PCs and laptops with at least 16GB of VRAM, which a modern GPU from Nvidia or Radeon would have. OpenAI said the model was trained using [high-compute reinforcement learning](#), which helps it excel at powering AI agents and call tools, such as web search or Python code execution, as part of its chain-of-thought process.

However, the model is text-only, meaning it will not be able to process or generate images and audio like the company's other models.

Also, the model has a habit of hallucinating a lot: gpt-oss-20b hallucinated in response to 53% of questions on PersonQA, OpenAI's in-house benchmark for measuring the accuracy of a model's knowledge about people.

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Microsoft says it will bring the model to macOS soon, as well as other devices, though the company did not name any more. Microsoft is also making both gpt-oss-20b and older model gpt-oss-120b available via its hosted Azure AI Foundry platform.

The two new models are also [available on Amazon's AWS](#).

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